



Presented by The High End

CARDBOARD FIRE TRUCK CAB

Life-Size Sit-In Fire Truck — Dashboard, Steering Wheel & Helmet

Build the fire truck. Wear the helmet. Save the living room.

AGES 4+	BOXES 2–3 Large Boxes	TIME 90 Minutes	DIFF Beginner *	PIECES 10 pcs
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CARDBOARD NEEDED:
2–3 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each)

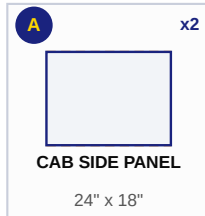
MISSION GOAL:
Build a sit-in fire truck cab with windshield, steering wheel, dashboard, light bar, hood — plus a wearable firefighter helmet. All exterior painted fire engine red.

1

STEP 1: BUILD THE CAB BOX

Lay the Cab Floor flat (fold marks show where walls attach). Stand both Side Panels upright on left and right of the floor. Tape all inside seams with 3+ layers. This is the shell your child sits inside.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



BUILD TO MATCH THIS

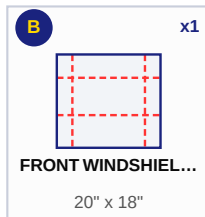
2

STEP 2: ADD THE WINDSHIELD

Tape the Front Windshield Panel upright at the front. Cut the windshield opening using the 4 cut lines shown on the template — top cut, bottom cut, left cut, right cut. Keep solid frame around all 4 sides. This is what the driver looks through.

SAFETY: Adult cuts all 4 window cut lines. Smooth edges — no sharp points.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



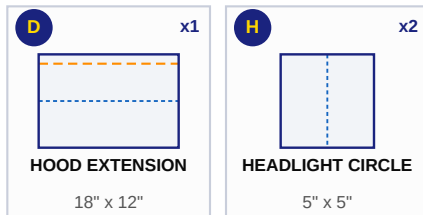
! ADULT ASSIST NEEDED

3

STEP 3: BUILD THE HOOD

Attach the Hood Extension at the base of the windshield using the fold mark. Score the midline (score mark on template) so the hood angles slightly downward. Attach a Headlight Circle to each front corner.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



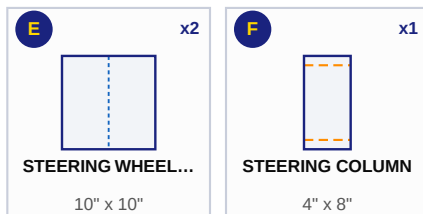
4

STEP 4: BUILD THE STEERING WHEEL

Cut both Steering Wheel circles (circle mark on template — trace a plate). Stack them and tape together for double thickness. Tape the Steering Column to the back of the wheel, then mount the whole assembly inside the cab at chest height when seated.

SAFETY: Steering wheel must not block the child's exit from the cab.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

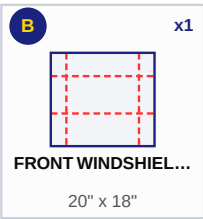


5

STEP 5: DRAW THE DASHBOARD

On the inside of the windshield panel below the window, draw a full dashboard — dials, gauges, a radio, a siren switch, a speedometer. The more detail, the better the build.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

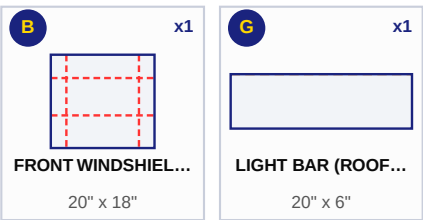


6

STEP 6: MOUNT THE LIGHT BAR

Tape the Light Bar across the top of the windshield panel (fold mark on template). Draw alternating red and blue light shapes across it. This is the emergency light bar — the most important outside detail.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

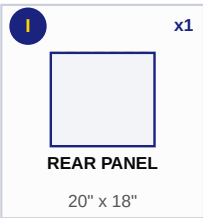


7

STEP 7: CLOSE THE REAR PANEL

Tape the Rear Panel upright at the back of the cab floor. The child should now sit inside an enclosed cab with an open top.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



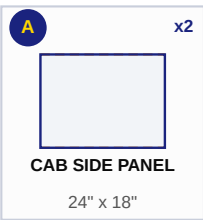
8

STEP 8: PAINT FIRE ENGINE RED

Paint the ENTIRE exterior fire engine red — every outside surface. This is the single most critical step. Add HEE FIRE DEPT or a badge number on the door. Add a flame logo on the side panel.

SAFETY: Water-based paint only in a ventilated space.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



9

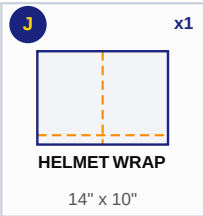
STEP 9: BUILD THE HELMET

Score the center of the Helmet Wrap so it curves around the head. Tape the side seam. Cut a front brim from scrap cardboard (attachment mark on template). Paint tan or brown. This is the helmet in the cover photo.

SAFETY:

Confirm child can see clearly and breathe with helmet on.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP

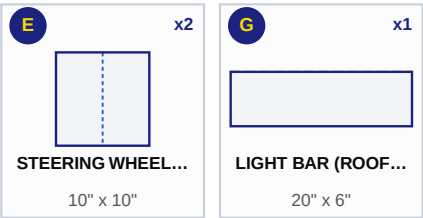


10

STEP 10: QUALITY CHECK

Child sits at the steering wheel. Full red paint outside. Light bar on top. Firefighter helmet on. Compare to cover photo. That's the standard.

PIECES USED IN THIS STEP



G

x1



LIGHT BAR (ROOF...

20" x 6"

QUALITY CHECK!

Does your build match the cover photo? Compare side by side before you call it done.

"Build It. Own It." — Tatum & Kash Cardboard Creations



CAB SIDE PANEL

24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

CAB SIDE PANEL

x2

BASE EDGE — tape to Cab Floor

TOP EDGE — Light Bar mounts here

24" × 18" (61 × 46 cm)
Left + right walls of the cab

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Left + right walls of the cab



FRONT WINDSHIELD PANEL

20" × 18" (51 × 46 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

FRONT WINDSHIELD PANEL

TOP CUT of windshield opening

BOTTOM CUT of windshield opening

20" × 18" (51 × 46 cm)

Cut large window at eye level

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

CUT — scissors or box cutter on this line

NOTE: Cut large window at eye level



CAB FLOOR / SEAT BASE

20" × 16" (51 × 41 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

CAB FLOOR / SEAT BASE

x1

FRONT EDGE — windshield panel stands here

REAR EDGE — rear panel stands here

20" × 16" (51 × 41 cm)
Child sits on this — double layer for strength

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Child sits on this — double layer for strength



HOOD EXTENSION

18" x 12" (46 x 30 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1

HOOD EXTENSION

FOLD EDGE attaches to bottom of windshield

SCORE MIDLINE — angled down slightly for hood slope

18" x 12" (46 x 30 cm)
Angles forward from base of windshield

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

SCORE — press hard with ruler but do NOT cut through

NOTE: Angles forward from base of windshield

E

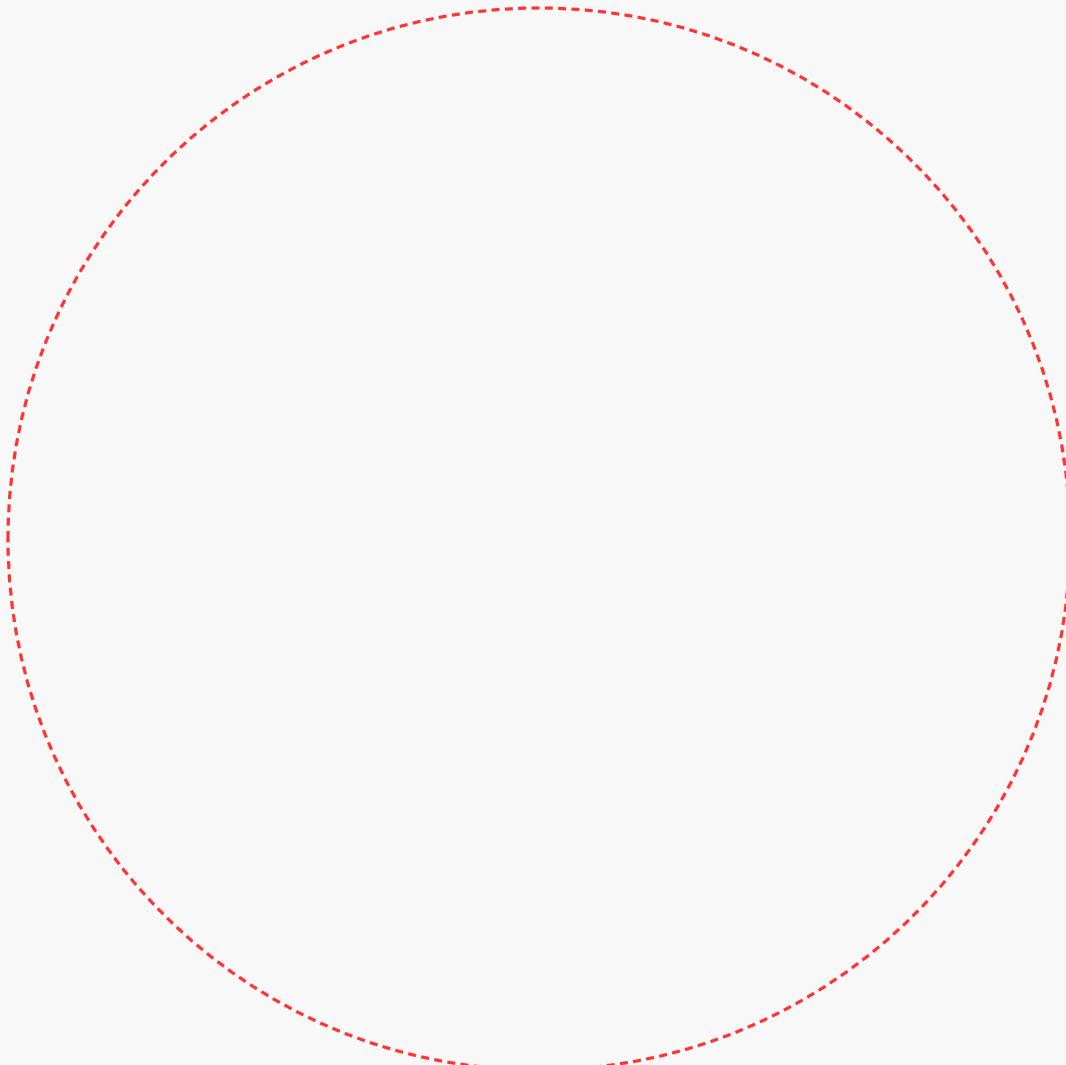
STEERING WHEEL (CIRCLE)

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm) | Cut ×2

CUT
x2

STEERING WHEEL (CIRCLE)

x2



CUT PERFECT CIRCLE — trace a plate or bowl. Stack 2 for rigidity.

10" × 10" (25 × 25 cm)
Stack both circles for thickness

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

OVAL — cut oval shape: pin string at center, trace with pencil

NOTE: Stack both circles for thickness



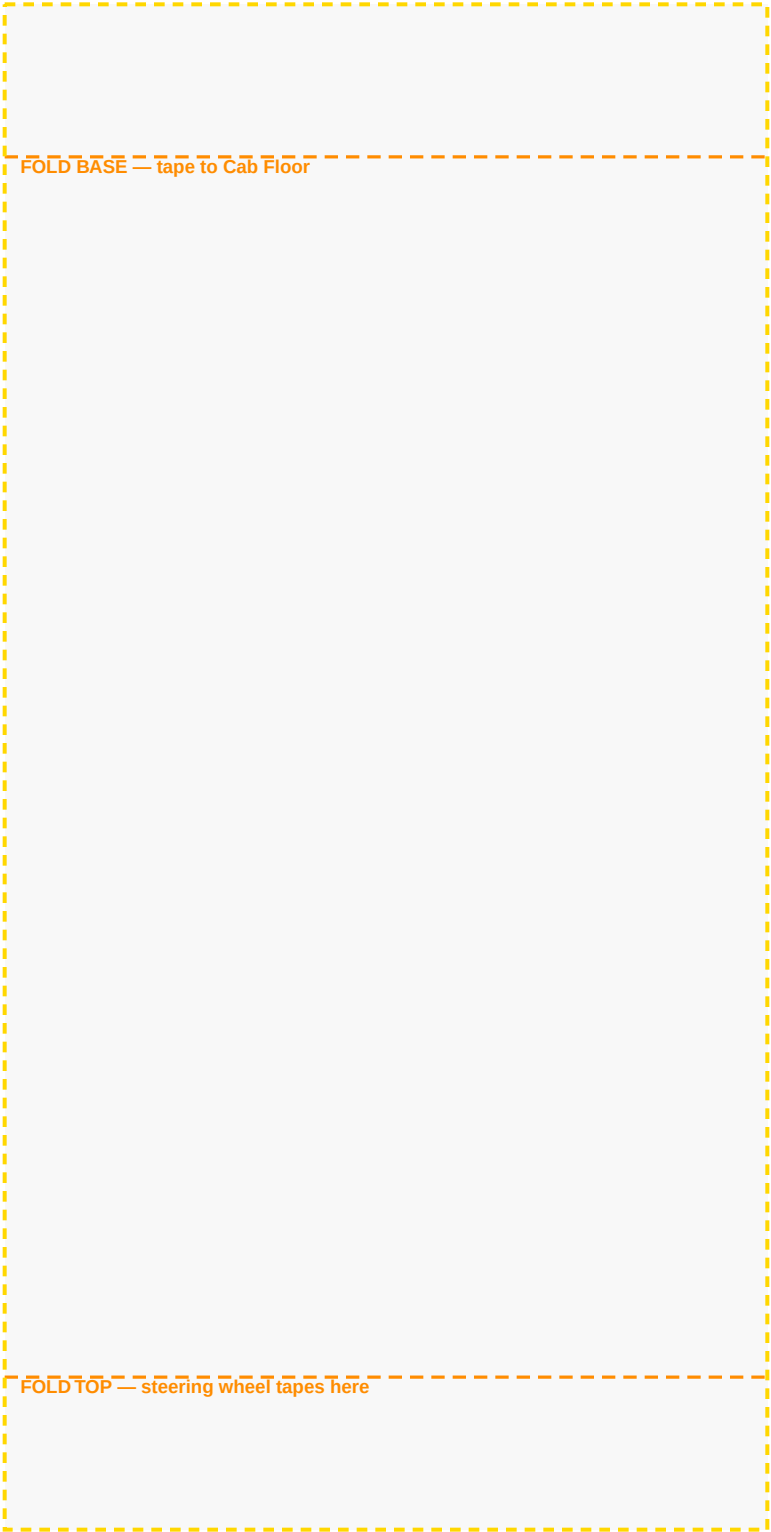
STEERING COLUMN

4" x 8" (10 x 20 cm) | Cut x1

CUT
x1

STEERING COLUMN

x1



4" x 8" (10 x 20 cm)
Supports steering wheel from dash

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Supports steering wheel from dash



LIGHT BAR (ROOF STRIP)

20" × 6" (51 × 15 cm) | Cut ×1

CUT
x1

LIGHT BAR (ROOF STRIP)

x1

EDGE — folds over cab top to attach

20" × 6" (51 × 15 cm)
Mount on top of cab — draw red/blue lights

MARK LEGEND FOR THIS PIECE:

FOLD — score lightly, then fold at this line

NOTE: Mount on top of cab — draw red/blue lights

WHAT YOU NEED — CARDBOARD FIRE TRUCK CAB

CARDBOARD PIECES — 10 TOTAL (2–3 Large Boxes (at least 24" × 36" (61 × 91 cm) each))

×2 Cab Side Panel
24" × 18"
Left + right walls of the cab

×1 Front Windshield Panel
20" × 18"
Cut large window at eye level

×1 Cab Floor / Seat Base
20" × 16"
Child sits on this — double layer for strength

×1 Hood Extension
18" × 12"
Angles forward from base of windshield

×2 Steering Wheel (circle)
10" × 10"
Stack both circles for thickness

×1 Steering Column
4" × 8"
Supports steering wheel from dash

×1 Light Bar (roof strip)
20" × 6"
Mount on top of cab — draw red/blue lights

×2 Headlight Circle
5" × 5"
Glue to front corners of hood

×1 Rear Panel
20" × 18"
Back wall of the cab

×1 Helmet Wrap
14" × 10"
Add front brim from scrap — paint tan

TOOLS & SUPPLIES

+ 2–3 large cardboard boxes

+ Box cutter — ADULT USE ONLY

+ Heavy scissors for kids

+ Packing tape (2+ rolls)

+ RED PAINT (most important — entire exterior is fire engine red)

+ Black + yellow markers for dashboard

+ Tan/brown paint for helmet

FUN FACT!

Real fire trucks pump 500 gallons of water per minute. Yours pumps 0 — but the bravery is the same.

CHALLENGE!

Fire drill! Set a 60-second timer. Can the whole family get to the fire truck and buckle in before the alarm goes off?

BUILD GUIDE — CARDBOARD FIRE TRUCK CAB

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